

Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7)

Chapter 1: Geographical Diversity of India

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	1 — Geographical Diversity of India
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Reason from the physical geography of India — its five regions, rivers, and how landforms shape life. Watch the classic traps: "all deserts are hot" (a desert means low rainfall, not heat), "tall mountains must be old" (the young Himalayas are still rising; the worn Aravallis are ancient), and confusing a delta with an estuary or the coral Lakshadweep with the volcanic Andamans. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

- India is called a "subcontinent" mainly because it is:
(A) a separate continent entirely cut off from Asia
(B) the smallest country in Asia
(C) a large, distinct landmass that is part of Asia but set apart by natural features
(D) an island lying in the middle of the Indian Ocean
- A geographer lists India's five physiographic regions. Which of the following does NOT belong on that list?
(A) the great mountain zone of the Himalayas (B) a frozen polar continent
(C) the desert region (D) the islands
- Climbing from the southern plains up to the highest snow peaks, in what order do you cross the three Himalayan ranges?
(A) Himadri → Himachal → Shivalik (B) Himachal → Shivalik → Himadri
(C) Himadri → Shivalik → Himachal (D) Shivalik → Himachal → Himadri
- The Himalayas are still growing taller today. The best reason is that:
(A) the Indian landmass keeps pushing north into Asia at about 5 cm a year
(B) glaciers add new rock to the peaks each winter
(C) rivers pile up silt on the mountain tops (D) the monsoon rains make the soil swell

- 5.** Ravi insists Ladakh cannot be a desert "because deserts are hot and Ladakh is freezing." His mistake is that:
- (A) Ladakh actually has heavy rainfall
 - (B) a desert is defined by very low rainfall, not by heat
 - (C) Ladakh lies below sea level
 - (D) deserts must always be covered in sand dunes
- 6.** Which natural features together act as India's "walls" to the north, west, and south?
- (A) the Aravallis, the Deccan Plateau, and the Ganga
 - (B) the Eastern Ghats, the Thar, and Chilika Lake
 - (C) the Himalayas, the Thar Desert with the Arabian Sea, and the Indian Ocean with the Bay of Bengal
 - (D) the Shivaliks, the Sundarbans, and the Lakshadweep islands
- 7.** The Northern Plains can support a very large population mainly because:
- (A) Himalayan rivers spread deep, mineral-rich alluvial soil over flat, well-watered land
 - (B) they are made of hardened volcanic lava
 - (C) they sit at a very high, cool altitude
 - (D) they are ringed by coral reefs that protect the farms
- 8.** Seashell fossils are sometimes found high in the Himalayan rock. This is best explained by the fact that:
- (A) ancient people carried shells up the mountains
 - (B) the floor of an old sea (the Tethys) was folded upward when India collided with Asia
 - (C) glaciers froze fish into the rock
 - (D) the shells fell from passing birds over millions of years
- 9.** Trace the chain that links a slow plate collision to the rich soil of the Northern Plains. Which ordering is correct?
- (A) collision raises the Himalayas → rivers grind the rock → rivers carry silt south → silt settles on the flat plains as fertile alluvium
 - (B) rivers carry silt south → collision raises the Himalayas → silt settles → rock grinds away
 - (C) silt settles on the plains → the Himalayas rise → rivers form → collision happens
 - (D) the Himalayas erode away completely → a sea floods the plains → silt sinks → rock rises
- 10.** Which pairing of a Himalayan range with its character is correct?
- (A) Himadri → lowest hills with dense forests
 - (B) Himachal → snow-covered all year with the giant peaks
 - (C) Shivalik → moderate climate with famous hill stations
 - (D) Himachal → moderate climate with hill stations like Shimla and Darjeeling
- 11.** The Himalayas are nicknamed the "Water Tower of Asia" because they:

- (A) collect monsoon rain in giant natural reservoirs of stone
- (B) store water as snow and ice and release it in summer to feed rivers like the Ganga, Indus and Brahmaputra
- (C) pump sea water uphill from the Bay of Bengal
- (D) are the only place in India where it ever rains

12. The Aravalli Hills are low and rounded today, whereas the Himalayas are towering and jagged. The reason is that:

- (A) the Aravallis are far younger and have not yet risen
- (B) the Himalayas are made of much harder rock
- (C) the Aravallis are among the oldest ranges and billions of years of erosion have worn them down
- (D) the Aravallis were never tall to begin with

13. If the Aravalli Hills were completely flattened by mining, the most likely consequence would be that:

- (A) the Thar Desert's sand would spread further east toward cities like Delhi
- (B) the Himalayas would stop growing
- (C) the Ganga would change direction
- (D) India would lose its western coastline

14. People of the Thar Desert scrub their utensils with sand and store rainwater in tanks called taanka or kunds. These customs arise mainly because:

- (A) sand is believed to make utensils shinier than water
- (B) the law forbids the use of river water there
- (C) the nights are too cold to wash with water
- (D) water is extremely scarce, so every drop must be saved

15. Which statement correctly contrasts the Western Ghats with the Eastern Ghats?

- (A) Both are equally tall, unbroken walls of the same rock
- (B) The Eastern Ghats are taller and unbroken; the Western Ghats are low and broken
- (C) The Western Ghats are taller and almost unbroken; the Eastern Ghats are lower and broken by rivers
- (D) The Western Ghats lie on the east coast and the Eastern Ghats on the west coast

16. Most major rivers of the Deccan Plateau — the Godavari, Krishna and Kaveri — empty into the Bay of Bengal in the east because:

- (A) the plateau tilts slightly toward the east, and rivers flow downhill along the slope
- (B) the Arabian Sea is too salty for rivers to enter
- (C) the Bay of Bengal is at a higher level and pulls the water in
- (D) the Western Ghats are lower than the Eastern Ghats

17. Southern India is called a "peninsular plateau." The two ideas in that phrase are that it is:

- (A) flat at sea level and surrounded by mountains on all four sides
- (B) a sandy desert AND a chain of islands
- (C) a river delta AND a mangrove forest
- (D) a raised, flat-topped landform AND land surrounded by water on three sides

18. The East Coast has wide river deltas (Godavari, Krishna), but the West Coast mostly does not. The geographical reason is that:

- (A) the West Coast gets no rain at all
- (B) long east-flowing rivers carry lots of sediment into the calm Bay of Bengal, while short, swift west-flowing rivers carry little into the open Arabian Sea
- (C) the East Coast has no rivers, only lakes
- (D) deltas can form only where the sea is salty

19. A delta and an estuary are NOT the same. The key difference is that:

- (A) a delta forms in the mountains while an estuary forms in a desert
- (B) an estuary is always larger than a delta
- (C) a delta is fertile land built up where a river drops heavy sediment in a calm sea, while an estuary is a funnel-shaped mouth where fresh and salt water mix without building much land
- (D) a delta is salty and an estuary is fresh

20. Which pairing of India's two island groups with how they formed is CORRECT?

- (A) Lakshadweep — coral; Andaman & Nicobar — volcanic
- (B) Lakshadweep — volcanic; Andaman & Nicobar — coral
- (C) Both groups are coral islands
- (D) Both groups are volcanic islands

21. A ship's log notes "low, flat islands ringed by coral reefs" near one Indian group and "steep, forested hills of volcanic rock" near another. The first group and its sea are:

- (A) the Andaman & Nicobar Islands, in the Bay of Bengal
- (B) the Lakshadweep Islands, in the Arabian Sea
- (C) the Sundarbans, in the Arabian Sea
- (D) the Lakshadweep Islands, in the Bay of Bengal

22. The Sundarbans is best described as:

- (A) a cold desert high in the Himalayas
- (B) a coral island chain in the Arabian Sea
- (C) a mangrove forest in the delta of the Ganga and Brahmaputra
- (D) a flat lava plateau in central India

23. The Royal Bengal Tiger's home in the Ganga–Brahmaputra delta is shared between:

- (A) India and Pakistan
- (B) India and Myanmar
- (C) India and Sri Lanka
- (D) India and Bangladesh

24. The hills of the Northeast (Garo, Khasi, Jaintia) receive some of the highest rainfall on Earth because:

- (A) moist monsoon winds are forced to rise sharply against the hills, cool, and shed heavy rain
- (B) they are the lowest land in India, so rain collects there
- (C) rivers flow uphill there and evaporate into clouds
- (D) the sea lies directly on top of the hills

25. The big lesson of the chapter — that India's very different regions still form one country — is summed up by the phrase:

- (A) survival of the fittest
- (B) divide and rule
- (C) unity in diversity
- (D) out of sight, out of mind

26. India shares the Indian Subcontinent with several neighbours. Which set is entirely made up of such neighbours?

- (A) China, Japan, Indonesia, Thailand
- (B) Iran, Iraq, Egypt, Kenya
- (C) Russia, France, Brazil, Canada
- (D) Pakistan, Bangladesh, Nepal, Bhutan, Sri Lanka

27. Why do geographers group a huge country like India into physical regions rather than treating it as one flat space?

- (A) because every part of India looks exactly the same
- (B) because grouping by height, slope, rock and water lets us compare regions and explain why life differs so much from place to place
- (C) because the regions were drawn by ancient kings
- (D) because each region speaks one single language

28. The three Himalayan ranges have three different climates. The main reason is that:

- (A) they were formed in three different centuries
- (B) only the lowest range ever gets sunlight
- (C) each range is made of a different colour of rock
- (D) as you go higher the air gets colder and thinner, so each range sits at a different temperature

29. Why do Himalayan rivers like the Ganga keep flowing even in the dry season, while many peninsular rivers shrink?

- (A) the Ganga is shorter, so it dries up more slowly
- (B) Himalayan rivers are fed by melting snow and glaciers that release water all year, while peninsular rivers depend mainly on the rains
- (C) peninsular rivers are blocked by the Aravallis
- (D) the Ganga is fed by the sea

30. "Perennial" rivers and "rain-fed" rivers differ in that:

- (A) perennial rivers flow all year (snow-fed), while rain-fed rivers swell in the rains and shrink in the dry season
- (B) perennial rivers exist only in deserts (C) rain-fed rivers never carry any water
- (D) perennial rivers flow only during the monsoon

31. Two students describe a "desert." Who is right?

- (A) Aarav: "A desert must be a hot, sandy place."
- (B) Neha: "A desert is any place with very low rainfall, hot or cold."
- (C) Both are equally correct
- (D) Neither — a desert is defined by being below sea level

32. Sand dunes in the Thar Desert can reach about 150 metres high. A sand dune is best described as:

- (A) a hill of rock left behind by a dried river (B) a heap of silt dropped by a river
- (C) a mound of coral built by sea animals
- (D) a ridge of sand built up and shaped by the wind

33. The Deccan Plateau is "tilted" rather than perfectly flat. The clearest evidence for this tilt is that:

- (A) its rivers mostly flow eastward into the Bay of Bengal
- (B) it has no rivers at all (C) its rivers flow in circles
- (D) its rivers all flow north into the Himalayas

34. A few peninsular rivers, the Narmada and Tapti, are unusual because they:

- (A) flow north into the Ganga (B) flow uphill into the Western Ghats
- (C) flow west into the Arabian Sea, against the general eastward slope
- (D) never reach the sea

35. The dense forests of the Deccan Plateau are home to tribal communities such as the:

- (A) Santhal, Gond, Baiga, Bhil and Korku (B) people of Ladakh's cold desert
- (C) coral fishers of Lakshadweep (D) mangrove dwellers of the Sundarbans

36. The Peninsular Plateau is described as one of India's most mineral-rich regions. The best reason is that:

- (A) rivers wash fresh minerals onto it from the Himalayas each year
- (B) it is built of very old, hard rock that stores minerals and coal
- (C) the sea deposits minerals on it at high tide
- (D) glaciers grind minerals into it from above

37. Which sequence correctly lists the five regions you "fly" over from the snowy north toward the southern islands?

- (A) islands → Himalayas → plains → desert → peninsula
- (B) desert → islands → peninsula → plains → Himalayas

(C) peninsula → islands → desert → plains → Himalayas

(D) Himalayas → Northern Plains → desert region → peninsula → islands

38. Why is the Aravalli range so effective at slowing the eastward spread of the Thar's sand?

(A) it is extremely tall and snow-covered

(B) it runs as a long ridge along the eastern edge of the Thar, physically blocking the wind-blown sand

(C) it is made of loose sand that absorbs more sand

(D) it lies far to the south of the desert

39. Mount Abu, at just over 1,700 m, is the highest point of which range?

(A) the Himadri

(B) the Western Ghats

(C) the Aravalli Hills

(D) the Shivalik Hills

40. India's coastline is over 7,500 km long. The West Coast differs from the East Coast in that the West Coast has:

(A) wide deltas built by long, slow rivers (B) the largest river deltas in India

(C) no rivers reaching the sea at all

(D) short, fast rivers forming coves, creeks and estuaries

41. Chilika and Pulicat are examples of:

(A) active volcanoes in the Andamans (B) peaks of the Himadri range

(C) glaciers of the Himalayas

(D) lakes and lagoons along the East Coast

42. "Khadar" and "bhangar" are two kinds of alluvium in the Northern Plains. Khadar is best described as:

(A) the old, higher silt, often less fertile and dotted with lime nodules

(B) hardened volcanic rock

(C) the new, light, very fertile silt a river spreads over its low floodplain with each flood

(D) the salty soil of a coastal delta

43. Why does the soil beneath the Northern Plains reach down for kilometres before hitting solid rock?

(A) the rock there sank into the sea

(B) for millions of years Himalayan rivers have ground down the mountains and dumped the sediment into the trough in front of them

(C) a volcano once buried the region in lava

(D) glaciers carved a deep canyon and filled it with ice

44. Barren Island, India's only active volcano, lies in which island group?

(A) the Andaman & Nicobar Islands

(B) the Lakshadweep Islands

(C) the Sundarbans

(D) the Maldives

45. Orographic (relief) rainfall happens because:

- (A) the sea heats up and rains directly on the coast
- (B) rivers evaporate faster in the mountains
- (C) moist winds are forced to rise over hills, cool, and drop their moisture as rain on the wind-facing side
- (D) deserts push their dryness onto nearby hills

46. The Western Ghats soak the west coast with monsoon rain for the same basic reason that the Khasi hills are among the wettest places on Earth. That shared reason is:

- (A) both lie beside large deserts
- (B) both are made of coral
- (C) both force moist monsoon winds to rise, cool and release heavy rain (orographic rainfall)
- (D) both are below sea level

47. If the Himalayas did NOT exist, the MOST likely change to north India's climate would be that:

- (A) cold, dry winds from Central Asia would sweep in, making winters far colder, and the monsoon would no longer be trapped, so there would be much less rain
- (B) it would become a tropical rainforest
- (C) the Ganga would flood every summer
- (D) the region would sink below the sea

48. Which feature is found in the COLD desert of Ladakh rather than in the hot Thar Desert?

- (A) golden sand dunes up to 150 m high
- (B) blazing-hot days and scorching sand
- (C) taanka and kund rainwater tanks for blistering heat
- (D) salty lakes like Pangong Tso, winters below -30°C , and animals like the snow leopard and ibex

49. Lakshadweep's islands are low and made of coral, while the Andamans are higher and volcanic. The deepest reason for this difference is that:

- (A) how an island forms decides what it is like — coral builds up in warm shallow seas, volcanoes rise where plates meet
- (B) Lakshadweep is much older than the Andamans
- (C) one group gets rain and the other does not
- (D) the two seas are at different temperatures only

50. A river meeting the sea builds a large delta rather than an estuary when it:

- (A) is very short and fast and meets a rough, open sea
- (B) carries a heavy load of sediment and empties into a calm sea
- (C) flows uphill before reaching the coast
- (D) carries no sediment at all

51. India's history shows traders and armies still entered despite its natural barriers. This tells us that India's "walls":

- (A) never existed
- (B) only blocked rivers, not people
- (C) made movement harder but did not completely seal the country off
- (D) were built by humans, not nature

52. Which single chain of mountains, deserts and seas best explains why India developed its own distinct climate and culture?

- (A) the natural barriers — Himalayas, Thar with the Arabian Sea, and the surrounding oceans — that limited easy movement in and out
- (B) random scattered hills with no pattern
- (C) the river deltas of the east coast alone
- (D) the coral reefs of Lakshadweep

53. Compared with the Shivalik Hills, the Himadri range is:

- (A) lower, forested and warm
- (B) the same height but drier
- (C) below sea level
- (D) far higher, snow-covered all year, and home to the giant peaks

54. A "peninsula" is a piece of land:

- (A) completely surrounded by water on all sides
- (B) surrounded by water on three sides
- (C) raised high with a flat top and steep sides
- (D) built where a river drops its sediment

55. Why is the Deccan Plateau's western edge (the Western Ghats) tall and unbroken, while its eastern edge (the Eastern Ghats) is low and chopped up?

- (A) the plateau is a single block tilted so its western rim stands high, while east-flowing rivers have cut through the eastern rim
- (B) the Western Ghats are far younger and still rising
- (C) the Eastern Ghats were flattened by the sea
- (D) the two ranges are made of completely different minerals

56. One way India's geography has helped UNITE its very different regions is that:

- (A) every region has identical weather
- (B) the Himalayas connect directly to the islands
- (C) great rivers like the Ganga link the mountains, plains and coasts, carrying people, goods and ideas between them
- (D) the whole country is one flat plain

57. Living root bridges and lush green valleys in the Northeast are a direct result of:

- (A) the cold desert climate of Ladakh
- (B) volcanic ash enriching the soil
- (C) salty sea spray from the Arabian Sea
- (D) the region's extremely heavy rainfall

58. A student must classify "Ladakh, the Thar, and the Sundarbans." The correct grouping by type is:

- (A) all three are hot deserts
- (B) Ladakh is a cold desert, the Thar is a hot desert, the Sundarbans is a mangrove delta

(C) all three are river deltas

(D) Ladakh and the Thar are deltas; the Sundarbans is a desert

59. Why are the Eight Thousanders (peaks over 8,000 m) found in the Himalayas and not in the Aravallis?

(A) the Aravallis are made of softer rock that cannot be tall

(B) the Aravallis are submerged under the sea

(C) the Himalayas are flat plateaus, not mountains

(D) the Himalayas are young, still-rising fold mountains, while the Aravallis are ancient and worn far down

60. Pulling the chapter together: which statement is the BEST summary of how India's geography shapes its life?

(A) all of India lives the same way because the land is the same everywhere

(B) only the Himalayas affect how Indians live; the other regions do not

(C) each physical region — mountains, plains, desert, plateau, coasts, islands — shapes its own climate, wildlife and way of life, yet rivers and shared history still bind them into one country

(D) geography has no effect on how or where people live in India

End of question paper. Maximum marks: 240. Marking: +4 correct, -1 wrong, 0 unattempted.

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 1: Geographical Diversity of India

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	C	11	B	21	B	31	B	41	D	51	C
2	B	12	C	22	C	32	D	42	C	52	A
3	D	13	A	23	D	33	A	43	B	53	D
4	A	14	D	24	A	34	C	44	A	54	B
5	B	15	C	25	C	35	A	45	C	55	A
6	C	16	A	26	D	36	B	46	C	56	C
7	A	17	D	27	B	37	D	47	A	57	D
8	B	18	B	28	D	38	B	48	D	58	B
9	A	19	C	29	B	39	C	49	A	59	D
10	D	20	A	30	A	40	D	50	B	60	C

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

- (C)** A "subcontinent" is a large, distinct landmass that is part of a continent but set apart from the rest by natural features. India is part of Asia, yet the Himalayas, the Thar and Arabian Sea, and the surrounding oceans wall it off — so it qualifies. It is NOT a separate continent (A) nor cut off entirely, and it is one of the largest, not the smallest (B), countries in Asia.
- (B)** The five physiographic regions are the Himalayan mountain zone, the Northern Plains, the desert region, the peninsula, and the islands — all real divisions geographers use (A, C, D). A "frozen polar continent" is not part of India at all, so it is the odd one out.
- (D)** Going UP from the southern plains you first meet the lowest hills (Shivalik), then the gentler middle range (Himachal), then the highest snow range (Himadri): Shivalik → Himachal → Himadri. Option (A) is the reverse — the order you would meet them coming DOWN from the peaks.
- (A)** India is still drifting north into Asia at about 5 cm a year, so the land keeps folding upward and the peaks keep rising. Glaciers (B) erode rock rather than add it; silt (C) builds

the plains, not the summits; rain (D) does not lift mountains.

5. (B) A desert is defined by very LOW rainfall, not by heat. Ladakh gets almost no rain (it lies in the Himalayan rain shadow), so it is a cold desert. Ravi wrongly assumes "desert = hot." Ladakh does not have heavy rain (A) nor lie below sea level (C), and not all deserts are sandy (D).

6. (C) India's natural walls are the Himalayas to the north, the Thar Desert with the Arabian Sea to the west, and the Indian Ocean with the Bay of Bengal to the south and east. Option (A) lists interior features (Aravallis, Deccan, Ganga) that do not frame the whole country.

7. (A) Himalayan rivers slow on the flat land and drop deep, mineral-rich alluvium year after year; level, well-watered, fertile ground supports a huge population. The plains are alluvial, not volcanic lava (B); they are low and warm, not high and cool (C); and they are inland, not ringed by reefs (D).

8. (B) Before the Himalayas existed, the Tethys Sea lay between India and Asia. When India collided, the old sea floor — with its shells — was squeezed and folded high into the rock. People (A), frozen fish (C) and birds (D) cannot explain marine fossils kilometres above any ocean.

9. (A) The cause-effect chain runs: the collision raises the Himalayas → rivers grind down the young rock → rivers carry the silt south → the silt settles on the flat plains as fertile alluvium. The other orderings scramble cause and effect (e.g. B has silt moving before the mountains exist).

10. (D) The Himachal (Lower Himalayas) has a moderate climate and the hill stations such as Shimla and Darjeeling. (A) wrongly gives the Himadri the lowest hills (it is the highest, snow-covered range); (B) and (C) swap the ranges' characters.

11. (B) The Himalayas store winter snow and ice and release it slowly in summer, feeding the Ganga, Indus and Brahmaputra all year — hence "Water Tower of Asia." They do not pump sea water (C), and they are far from the only rainy part of India (D).

12. (C) The taller-means-older idea is backwards. The Aravallis are among the OLDEST ranges (about 2.5 billion years) and billions of years of erosion have worn them low; the Himalayas are YOUNG and still rising. So (A) reverses their ages, and rock hardness (B) is not the reason.

13. (A) The Aravallis run as a ridge along the eastern edge of the Thar and physically slow the wind-blown sand. Remove them and the desert's sand would spread further east toward Delhi. They have nothing to do with the Himalayas' growth (B), the Ganga's course (C), or the west coast (D).

- 14. (D)** In the Thar, water is extremely scarce, so people scour utensils with sand and store rainwater in taanka/kunds — every drop is saved. Sand is not used for shine (A), there is no such law (B), and the customs are about saving water, not avoiding cold nights (C).
- 15. (C)** The Western Ghats are taller and almost unbroken, running like a wall near the west coast; the Eastern Ghats are lower and broken into chunks where east-flowing rivers cut through them. (B) swaps them, (A) treats them as identical, and (D) puts each on the wrong coast.
- 16. (A)** The Deccan tilts slightly to the east, and rivers flow downhill along the slope — so the Godavari, Krishna and Kaveri run east into the Bay of Bengal. Saltiness (B) does not block rivers, the Bay is not higher (C), and the Ghats' heights do not set river direction (D).
- 17. (D)** "Peninsular plateau" packs two ideas: a plateau (a raised, flat-topped landform) and a peninsula (land surrounded by water on three sides). Southern India is both. The other options describe deserts, deltas or sea-level flats, not this landform.
- 18. (B)** Long east-flowing peninsular rivers gather lots of sediment and meet the calm Bay of Bengal, so they build big deltas; short, swift west-flowing rivers carry little sediment into the open Arabian Sea, so they form estuaries instead. The West Coast does have rivers and rain (A, C), and deltas are not about saltiness (D).
- 19. (C)** A delta is fertile land BUILT UP where a river drops heavy sediment into a calm sea; an estuary is a funnel-shaped mouth where fresh and salt water mix without building much land. They are not split by mountain-vs-desert (A), by size (B), or by being salty-vs-fresh (D).
- 20. (A)** Lakshadweep (Arabian Sea) is built of coral; the Andaman & Nicobar Islands (Bay of Bengal) are volcanic. Option (B) reverses this — the single most common island mix-up — and (C), (D) wrongly make both groups the same type.
- 21. (B)** "Low, flat, coral-ringed" describes the Lakshadweep Islands, which lie in the Arabian Sea to the west; the "steep, volcanic, forested" group is the Andaman & Nicobar Islands in the Bay of Bengal. (A) names the volcanic group, and the Sundarbans (C) is a delta, not an island chain.
- 22. (C)** The Sundarbans is a mangrove forest in the delta of the Ganga and Brahmaputra. It is neither a cold Himalayan desert (A), a coral chain (B), nor a lava plateau (D).
- 23. (D)** The Sundarbans, home of the Royal Bengal Tiger, lies in the Ganga–Brahmaputra delta and is shared roughly half-and-half by India and Bangladesh. Pakistan, Myanmar and Sri Lanka (A, B, C) do not share this delta.

24. (A) Moist monsoon winds hitting the Northeast hills are forced to rise sharply, cool, and dump heavy rain (orographic rainfall), making the region among the wettest on Earth. The hills are high, not low (B); rivers do not flow uphill (C); and the sea is not on top of them (D).

25. (C) The chapter's theme — different regions still forming one country — is "unity in diversity." The other phrases describe competition, control or neglect, not unity.

26. (D) India's Subcontinent neighbours include Pakistan, Bangladesh, Nepal, Bhutan and Sri Lanka. (A) lists distant East/Southeast Asian states, (B) West Asian/African states, and (C) countries on other continents.

27. (B) A huge, varied country cannot be understood as one flat space; grouping land by height, slope, rock and water lets geographers compare regions and explain why people farm, build and live so differently. The regions are not all alike (A), drawn by kings (C), or defined by single languages (D).

28. (D) As you go higher the air gets colder and thinner, so the three ranges sit at three different temperatures — hence three climates, plants and settlement patterns. They were not built in different centuries (A), all get sunlight (B), and rock colour (C) does not set climate.

29. (B) Himalayan rivers are fed by melting snow and glaciers that release water even in the dry season (perennial), while many peninsular rivers depend on the rains and shrink afterward. Length (A) and the Aravallis (C) are irrelevant, and the Ganga is fed by the mountains, not the sea (D).

30. (A) Perennial rivers flow all year because snow and glaciers keep feeding them; rain-fed rivers swell during the rains and shrink in the dry season. The other options misdescribe perennial rivers as desert-only, monsoon-only, or claim rain-fed rivers never carry water.

31. (B) Neha is right: a desert is any place with very low rainfall — hot OR cold — as Ladakh proves. Aarav (A) repeats the "deserts must be hot and sandy" misconception, so they are not both correct (C), and being below sea level (D) has nothing to do with it.

32. (D) A sand dune is a ridge or hill of sand built up and shaped by the wind (in the Thar, up to about 150 m). It is not dried-river rock (A), river silt (B), or coral (C).

33. (A) Because rivers flow downhill, the fact that the Deccan's major rivers run eastward into the Bay of Bengal is the clearest sign the plateau tilts east. It clearly has rivers (B), they do not flow in circles (C), and they do not run north into the Himalayas (D).

34. (C) Most peninsular rivers flow east, but the Narmada and Tapi are the exceptions that flow WEST into the Arabian Sea, against the general eastward slope. They do not join

the Ganga (A), flow uphill (B), or fail to reach the sea (D).

35. (A) The Deccan's dense forests shelter tribal communities such as the Santhal, Gond, Baiga, Bhil and Korku. The others name people of Ladakh, Lakshadweep and the Sundarbans — different regions entirely.

36. (B) The plateau is built of very old, hard rock that stores minerals and coal, making it one of India's most mineral-rich regions. Rivers (A) and glaciers (D) do not import minerals there, and the inland plateau is not fed minerals by the tide (C).

37. (D) Flying from the snowy north toward the southern islands, the regions come in the order Himalayas → Northern Plains → desert region → peninsula → islands. The other sequences scramble this north-to-south order.

38. (B) The Aravalli range runs as a long ridge along the eastern edge of the Thar, so it physically blocks and slows the wind-blown sand. It is low and worn, not tall and snowy (A); it is rock, not loose sand (C); and it borders the desert rather than lying far south of it (D).

39. (C) Mount Abu (just over 1,700 m) is the highest point of the Aravalli Hills. It is not in the Himadri (A), the Western Ghats (B), or the Shivaliks (D).

40. (D) The West Coast has short, fast rivers from the Western Ghats that form coves, creeks and estuaries — not wide deltas. The big deltas (A, B) belong to the East Coast, and the West Coast certainly has rivers reaching the sea (C).

41. (D) Chilika and Pulicat are lakes/lagoons along the East Coast. They are not Andaman volcanoes (A), Himadri peaks (B), or glaciers (C).

42. (C) Khadar is the NEW alluvium — light, very fertile fresh silt a river spreads over its low floodplain with each flood. The OLD, higher, less fertile silt with lime nodules is bhangar (A). It is not volcanic rock (B) or coastal salt soil (D).

43. (B) For millions of years Himalayan rivers have ground down the rising mountains and dumped the sediment into the trough in front of them, filling it kilometres deep before solid rock. The rock did not sink into the sea (A); no volcano (C) or glacier-canyon (D) built the plains.

44. (A) Barren Island, India's only active volcano, lies in the Andaman & Nicobar group (volcanic islands). Lakshadweep is coral (B), the Sundarbans is a delta (C), and the Maldives is a separate country (D).

45. (C) Orographic (relief) rainfall occurs when moist winds are forced to rise over hills, cool, and drop their moisture as rain on the wind-facing side. It is not direct sea heating (A), faster river evaporation (B), or deserts "pushing" dryness (D).

46. (C) Both the Western Ghats and the Khasi hills force moist monsoon winds to rise, cool and release heavy rain — the same orographic mechanism — which is why both are so wet. They are not defined by neighbouring deserts (A), coral (B), or being below sea level (D).

47. (A) Without the Himalayan wall, cold, dry Central-Asian winds would sweep in (far colder winters) and the monsoon would no longer be trapped (much less rain). It would not turn into rainforest (B); the loss of the Himalayas would mean less, not more, river flooding (C); and the land would not sink (D).

48. (D) The COLD desert of Ladakh has salty lakes like Pangong Tso, winters below -30°C , and animals such as the snow leopard and ibex. Golden dunes and scorching heat (A, B) and the taanka/kund tanks for heat (C) belong to the HOT Thar.

49. (A) How an island forms decides what it is like: coral builds up in warm, shallow seas (low Lakshadweep), while volcanoes rise where plates meet (higher, volcanic Andamans). Age (B), rainfall (C) and sea temperature alone (D) do not explain the coral-vs-volcanic split.

50. (B) A river builds a large delta when it carries a heavy load of sediment AND empties into a calm sea — so the sediment settles and piles up. A short, fast river meeting a rough open sea (A) or carrying no sediment (D) forms an estuary or none; rivers do not flow uphill (C).

51. (C) History shows traders and armies still entered, so India's natural barriers made movement HARDER but did not seal the country off completely. They clearly existed (A), blocked more than rivers (B), and were made by nature, not humans (D).

52. (A) India developed its own climate and culture largely because its natural barriers — the Himalayas, the Thar with the Arabian Sea, and the surrounding oceans — limited easy movement in and out, keeping weather and people somewhat "inside." Scattered hills (B), east-coast deltas (C) or Lakshadweep's reefs (D) cannot do that on their own.

53. (D) The Himadri (Greater Himalayas) is far higher than the Shivaliks, snow-covered all year, and home to the giant peaks. It is not lower and warm (A), the same height (B), or below sea level (C).

54. (B) A peninsula is land surrounded by water on THREE sides. Surrounded on all sides (A) would be an island; (C) describes a plateau; (D) describes a delta.

55. (A) The plateau is a single ancient block tilted so its western rim (the Western Ghats) stands high and unbroken, while east-flowing rivers have cut through the eastern rim (the lower, broken Eastern Ghats). Age (B), the sea (C) and minerals (D) do not explain the contrast.

56. (C) Great rivers like the Ganga link the mountains, plains and coasts, carrying people, goods and ideas between very different regions — a force for unity. Weather is not identical (A), the Himalayas do not touch the islands (B), and India is not one flat plain (D).

57. (D) Living root bridges and lush green valleys in the Northeast result directly from the region's extremely heavy rainfall. They are not products of Ladakh's cold desert (A), volcanic ash (B), or Arabian sea spray (C).

58. (B) Classifying by type: Ladakh is a COLD desert, the Thar is a HOT desert, and the Sundarbans is a mangrove DELTA — three different things. They are not all hot deserts (A), all deltas (C), or mislabelled as in (D).

59. (D) The Eight Thousanders are in the Himalayas because the Himalayas are young, still-rising fold mountains, whereas the Aravallis are ancient and worn far down. Rock softness (A), being submerged (B) or being "flat plateaus" (C) are not the reasons.

60. (C) The best summary: each physical region — mountains, plains, desert, plateau, coasts, islands — shapes its own climate, wildlife and way of life, yet rivers and shared history bind them into one country (unity in diversity). The other options deny geography's role or oversimplify it.